

Brand identity *foundation.*

Logo, disclosure icons, color tokens, image direction, and motion — the operating layer beneath every screen, pouch, and ad.

A wordmark you can whisper.

Instrument Serif sets the tone — editorial, calm, restrained. The italic stem on "varitea" carries the warmth. No mascot. No motto. The word is the brand.



× = cap-height of "v"

A diagram showing the wordmark "drink varitea." with a dashed box around it. The box is defined by the cap-height of the lowercase "v" on all sides. A small "x" is placed to the right of the box.

×

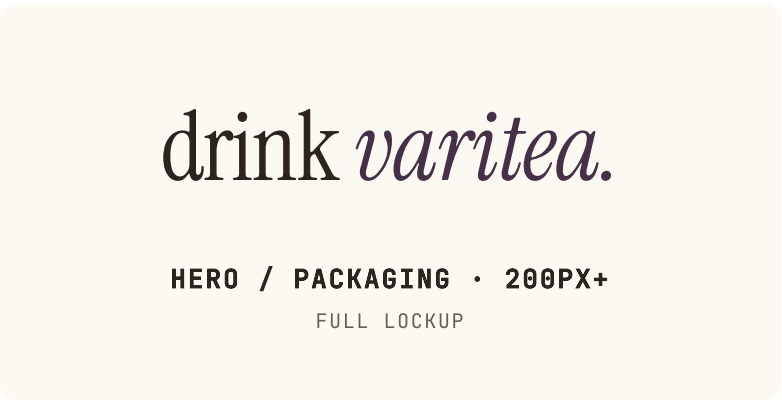
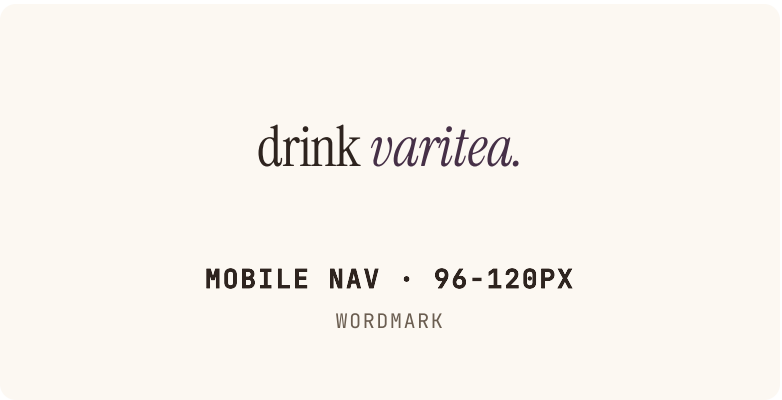
Clear space & minimums

Clear space: minimum margin equal to the cap-height of the lowercase "v" on all sides.

Minimum digital: 96px wide for primary wordmark. 24px for monogram.

Minimum print: 24mm wide for primary wordmark. 8mm for monogram.

Never: outline the wordmark, stretch, recolor outside palette, set in all-caps, or pair with a tagline below 11px.



Honest labels, no fine print.

Every pouch and product card carries one of three icons that disclose how the flavor was achieved. Designed for ten-foot legibility on packaging and 16px clarity in the cart.



Botanicals only

TIER 1 • GREEN

Tea leaves, herbs, flowers, fruit pieces. No flavoring agents — natural or otherwise. The leaf and the botanical do the work.

#5A8A4F	#EEF2EA	24-200px
Icon	Field	Range



Naturally flavored

TIER 2 • YELLOW

Botanicals plus natural flavoring derived from food-source extracts. No artificial compounds. Most blends in the First Sip Box live here.

#D9A93B	#FAF1DD	24-200px
Icon	Field	Range



Artificially flavored

TIER 3 • RED

Contains synthetic flavor compounds. We use this rarely. When we do, we say so up front — never hidden in fine print.

#B05A4A	#F5E5E1	24-200px
Icon	Field	Range

Usage rules

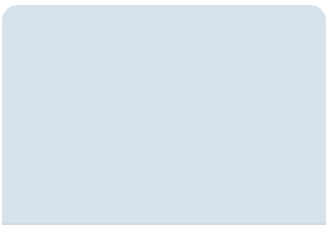
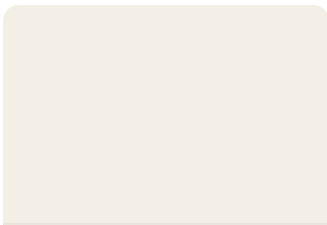
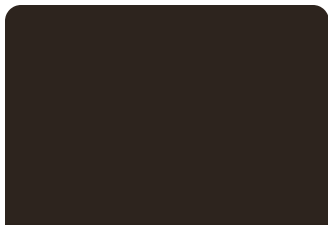
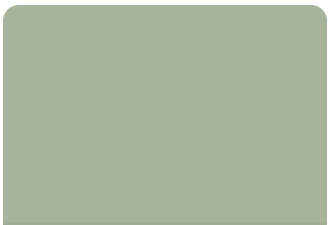
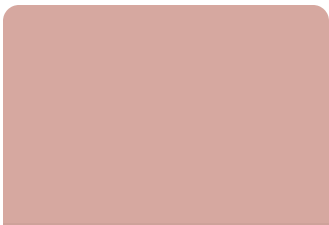
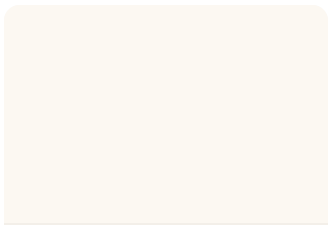
- Every pouch back panel must carry exactly one disclosure icon — no exceptions.
- Product cards on web display the icon at 24×24px next to the price.
- Cart line items show the icon at 16×16px before the tea name.
- Never combine icons or invent a hybrid tier.
- Icon field color (light tint) is part of the icon — never strip the disc.
- On dark backgrounds, invert to the field color as the icon and the stroke as the disc.
- Below 16px, drop the field and use the stroke color as a solid filled glyph.
- Never translate the labels — these are the only English-only assets in the system.

Two palettes, one world.

Packaging tokens live on physical pouches and printable cards. Digital tokens drive the web app, ads, and emails. They share the same warmth — paper, plum, amber — and are reconciled so the brand never breaks between hand and screen.

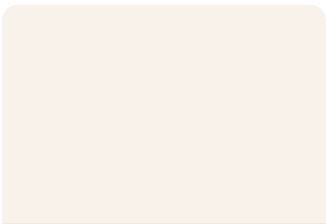
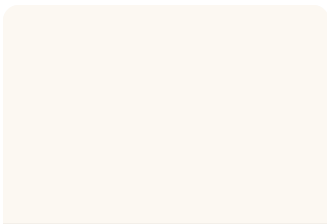
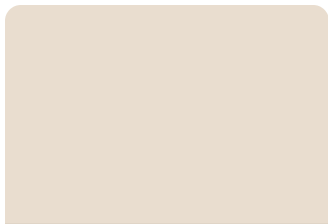
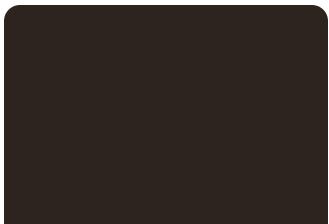
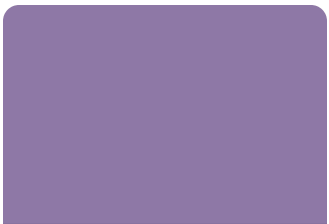
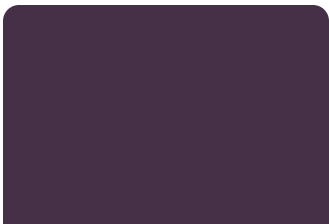
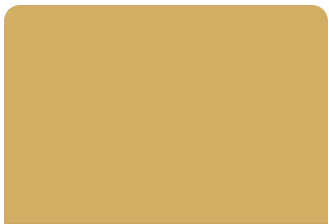
Packaging palette

Soul Document source · matte everywhere except tea leaves, brewed tea, glass jars, and wet botanicals.
Home-printer safe at 100% ink load.

						
Powder blue #D8E2EB POUCH FIELD · FLORAL	Paper #F3EFE7 CARD STOCK · BASE	Tea leaf #2D241E BOLD · POUCH FIELD	Amber #C68845 BOLD ACCENT · SEAL	Sage #A7B39A GREEN POUCH FIELD	Blush #D6A8A0 FLORAL ACCENT	Cream #FCF8F2 LABEL FILL

Digital palette

UX Workspace source · drives the web app, landing pages, checkout, and email. Hits WCAG AA on all body text combinations.

						
Warm white #F8F2EA PAGE BACKGROUND	Cream #FCF8F2 CARD SURFACE	Linen #E9DDCF BORDERS · DIVIDERS	Tea charcoal #2E241F BODY TEXT	Lavender #8E78A6 PRIMARY CTA	Plum brown #463047 HOVER · STEM ACCENT	Amber accent #D2AE64 HIGHLIGHT · PRICE

How the two palettes connect



Amber bridge. Pouch amber → digital amber accent. Same warmth, slightly more luminous on screen.

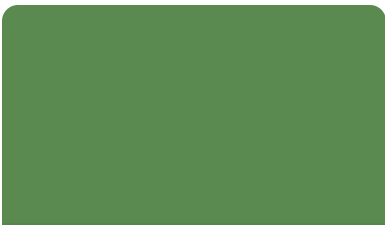
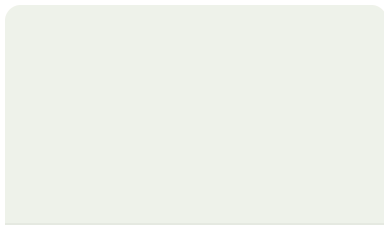
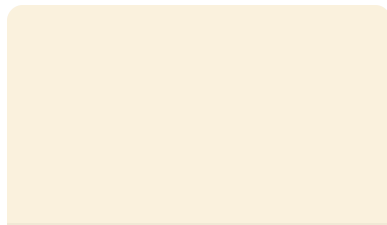
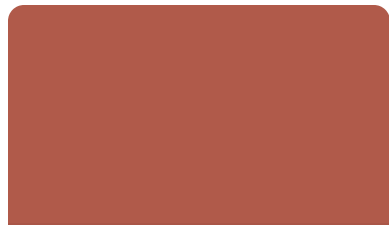
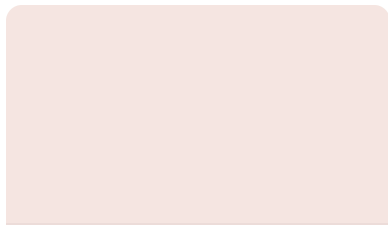


Tea-dark bridge. Pouch tea-leaf → digital tea-charcoal. Effectively identical; ensures cohesion print-to-pixel.



Paper bridge. Card-stock paper → warm-white background. Print is cooler; screen runs slightly warmer to read as paper.

Disclosure colors

					
Disclosure green #5A8A4F BOTANICALS ONLY	Green field #EEF2EA TIER 1 DISC	Disclosure yellow #D9A93B NATURAL FLAVOR	Yellow field #FAF1DD TIER 2 DISC	Disclosure red #B05A4A ARTIFICIAL FLAVOR	Red field #F5E5E1 TIER 3 DISC

DRINK VARITEA · BRAND IDENTITY FOUNDATION

04 / 07 · COLOR TOKENS

12 hero shots, one papercraft world.

Every image earns its place by removing an anxiety or strengthening the 5-second belief. Briefs below are production-ready: prompt, model, aspect, and intended placement. Matte everywhere — gloss only on leaves, liquid, and glass.

Production rules. Default model: **Nano Banana Pro** for premium hero work. Switch to **GPT Image 2** when packaging copy must be legible. Aspect ratios are capped to platform-supported sizes (1:1, 3:4, 4:3, 9:16, 16:9). Never use stock photography. Never composite identifiable real people.

IMG-01 • HERO ANCHOR

First Sip Box, open papercraft scene

LANDING HERO • 16:9 • NANO BANANA PRO

Editorial overhead-angle papercraft scene. Open First Sip Box on a powder-blue paper field with soft side-light from camera-left. Three pouches (deep brown, powder blue, sage) arranged in a fan. Glossy dark tea leaves catching the light at the box edge. Cut-paper hills suggested in the soft-focus background. Warm shadows. No text in image.

Crop 16:9 Mood Calm • tactile Output Hero • OG image

IMG-03 • FALLING LEAVES

Glossy tea leaves mid-fall

SCROLL MOMENT • 4:3 • NANO BANANA PRO

Stage-lit slow-motion arrangement of seven glossy dark tea leaves frozen mid-fall on a matte cream paper backdrop. Each leaf catches a single warm highlight. Soft drop shadows beneath. Minimal composition — empty space dominates. Editorial product-art feel, not photography of real leaves.

Crop 4:3 Mood Slow • special Output Scroll reveal frame

IMG-05 • FLORAL CHARACTER

Lavender & Mango pouch portrait

PDP • 4:3 • NANO BANANA PRO

Three-quarter portrait of the Lavender & Mango pouch — powder-blue matte paper with blush accent. Dried lavender sprigs and a single matte mango slice paper-cut piece staged at the base. Cool morning light, slightly higher angle. Quiet composition. Glossy hint on a single dried lavender bud.

Crop 4:3 Mood Floral • calm Output Product page hero

IMG-07 • BREWING MOMENT

Glass cup, amber tea pouring

TRUST HERO • 1:1 • NANO BANANA PRO

Square crop of a small clear glass cup catching warm side-light. Amber tea being poured from a small paper-cut teapot — pour mid-arc, glossy stream. Matte powder-blue paper field. Steam suggested with a single rising paper cutout curl. Tea-leaf shadow on the field below the cup. Refined, slow, premium.

Crop 1:1 Mood Sensory • trust Output Trust block • ads

IMG-09 • BOX UNBOXING

Partial reveal, lid lifting

LIFECYCLE HERO • 16:9 • NANO BANANA PRO

Three-quarter angle of the First Sip Box with lid lifting at 30 degrees. Inside reveal: three pouches in their slot, three brew cards tucked at the front, orientation card peeking under the lid. Soft paper-cut shadows under the lid. Powder-blue field. Light source from camera-right. Subject offset to the left third for headline safe-area.

Crop 16:9 Mood Anticipation Output Email • ads

IMG-11 • QUIZ REWARD

Three pouches assembling

QUIZ OUTCOME • 16:9 • NANO BANANA PRO

Wide editorial composition of three pouches sliding into the box from the top of frame on paper rails — captured mid-motion, gentle blur on the moving pieces. Each pouch a different field color: deep brown, powder blue, sage. Matte paper world, glossy tea-leaf accents at base. Cinematic side-light, warm. Composition centered with negative space top and bottom.

Crop 16:9 Mood Resolution Output Quiz "your box" screen

IMG-02 • HERO VERTICAL

Box held in hands, paper sky

MOBILE HERO • 9:16 • NANO BANANA PRO

Vertical close-up of two hands holding the closed First Sip Box against a layered powder-blue paper sky. Matte texture on box and hands. Tiny floating cutout tea leaf in the upper third. Side-light from above-right. Shallow paper-cut depth — three planes of hills receding behind. Centered subject, lower-third copy safe-area.

Crop 9:16 Mood Intimate Output Mobile • TikTok

IMG-04 • BOLD BLACK CHARACTER

Morning Dark pouch portrait

PDP • 4:3 • NANO BANANA PRO

Three-quarter portrait of the Morning Dark pouch — deep tea-leaf brown matte paper with amber accent band. Glossy dark tea leaves scattered to the left. Tiny cinnamon stick and orange-peel curl staged like still life. Side-light from camera-left, warm color temperature. Pouch label kept lower-right, no readable text required.

Crop 4:3 Mood Warm • bold Output Product page hero

IMG-06 • SMOOTH GREEN CHARACTER

Tangerine Grove pouch portrait

PDP • 4:3 • NANO BANANA PRO

Three-quarter portrait of the Tangerine Grove pouch — sage paper green with cream accent. A spiral of tangerine peel and matte green-tea leaves arranged at the base. Bright but soft daylight from above-right. Paper-cut citrus leaf in the background plane. One glossy droplet on the peel for the gloss exception.

Crop 4:3 Mood Fresh • smooth Output Product page hero

IMG-08 • BREW CARD HERO

Three cards laid out, paper detail

CONFIDENCE BLOCK • 4:3 • GPT IMAGE 2

Top-down arrangement of three matte brew cards staggered on a paper field. Cards readable, sentence-case labels: "Morning Dark", "Lavender & Mango", "Tangerine Grove". Soft side-light. Tiny botanical cutout next to each card. Cards use cream paper with colored accent stripes — amber, blush, sage. Composition wide enough for safe-area copy left or right.

Crop 4:3 Mood Reassuring Output Confidence section

IMG-10 • RITUAL DETAIL

Pouch open, leaf measuring spoon

UGC PATTERN • 1:1 • NANO BANANA PRO

Square overhead of an open Morning Dark pouch with a small wooden measuring spoon resting at the lip, two grams of dark cinnamon-orange tea blend on the spoon. Matte paper field. Single warm light from above-left. Looks made by hand at a kitchen counter. Honest, not styled-luxury.

Crop 1:1 Mood Honest • ritual Output Instagram • UGC

IMG-12 • QUIET CLOSER

Closed box, end of scene

FOOTER • CHECKOUT • 1:1 • NANO BANANA PRO

Centered square of the closed First Sip Box on a soft cream paper field. Side-light from camera-left. Tiny glossy tea leaf resting on the lid corner. Minimal — almost a still life. The composition should feel like the end of a sentence. Generous negative space on all sides for typography overlay if needed.

Crop 1:1 Mood Closure Output Footer • checkout confirmation

Six named animations.

Motion reveals information, never decorates. Every animation respects prefers-reduced-motion and falls back to a static state. Timing curves are paper-physics — slower than UI, faster than cinema.

paperRise

600ms

Hero box and pouches enter on first load. Establishes "this was placed for you".

```
trigger page load · 80ms after fonts
from y: 24px · opacity: 0
to y: 0 · opacity: 1
easing cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)
```

```
const paperRise = { initial: { y: 24, opacity: 0 }, animate: { y: 0, opacity: 1 },
transition: { duration: 0.6, ease: [0.16, 1, 0.3, 1] } }
```

leafFall

2400ms

Scroll-linked tea leaves drift across the hero into three streams.

```
trigger scroll 0% → 40%
path y: 0 → 800px · x: ±60px sine
rotation -12° → +18°
easing linear (scroll-linked)
```

```
const { scrollYProgress } = useScroll() const y = useTransform(scrollYProgress, [0, 0.4], [0, 800]) const rotate = useTransform(scrollYProgress, [0, 0.4], [-12, 18])
// respect reduced-motion: skip transform
```

brewPour

1800ms

Amber liquid fills a paper cup in the brew-timer micro-interaction.

```
trigger timer start
property SVG mask y: 100% → 0%
color #D2AE64 · gradient stop
easing cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.6, 1)
```

```
const brewPour = { initial: { clipPath: 'inset(100% 0 0 0)' }, animate: { clipPath: 'inset(0 0 0 0)' }, transition: { duration: 1.8, ease: [0.4, 0, 0.6, 1] } }
```

quizReveal

450ms

Quiz answer cards slide in stagger-children, paper-on-paper.

```
trigger question mount
stagger 80ms between children
from x: 16px · opacity: 0
easing cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)
```

```
const quizReveal = { animate: { transition: { staggerChildren: 0.08 } } } const answerItem = { initial: { x: 16, opacity: 0 }, animate: { x: 0, opacity: 1 } }
```

cartConfirm

320ms

Add-to-cart micro-confirmation. Subtle, never bouncy.

```
trigger add to cart click
sequence scale 1 → 0.96 → 1.02 → 1
color flash amber accent 120ms
easing cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.2, 0.64, 1)
```

```
const cartConfirm = { animate: { scale: [1, 0.96, 1.02, 1] }, transition: { duration: 0.32, times: [0, 0.3, 0.7, 1], ease: 'easeOut' } }
```

colorShift

800ms

Background field shifts hue when the user picks a tea role. Soft, slow.

```
trigger role selection
from warm-white #F8F2EA
to role tint · 6% saturation
easing cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)
```

```
const colorShift = { animate: { backgroundColor: roleColor }, transition: { duration: 0.8, ease: [0.4, 0, 0.2, 1] } } // roleColor: floral=#F2E6E2 · green=#EAEFE5 · bold=#EDE3D5
```

Decisions before the next build.

This document is the operating layer for Sprint B (quiz flow, mobile wireframes) and Sprint C (post-purchase journey). Nothing in those sprints should violate what's set here.

What this unlocks now

- **Brand Agent** can render any pouch, card, or label using fixed packaging tokens.
- **Web App Agent** can build landing, PDP, and checkout against the digital palette with zero ambiguity.
- **Paid Growth Agent** has 12 production-ready image briefs sized for every ad placement.
- **Social Agent** can ship Instagram and TikTok content from IMG-02, IMG-07, IMG-10.
- **Lifecycle Agent** can theme email templates with the bridge tokens — print-true and screen-true.
- **SEO Agent** can request OG/Twitter card art using IMG-01 and IMG-09 as the canonical thumbnails.

What's still open

- **Quiz flow** — 6 screens, branching logic, copy, and the "your box" reveal. Sprint B.
- **Mobile wireframe** — 375px landing, PDP, cart, checkout. Sprint B.
- **Post-purchase journey** — box contents script, Day 0–7 Klaviyo sequence, NPS prompt. Sprint C.
- **Licensed fonts** — Instrument Serif stands in for Canela; DM Sans stands in for Neue Haas. License before paid traffic.
- **Trademark check** — wordmark "drink varitea." needs USPTO search before any public ad spend.
- **Photography test** — first three image briefs should be rendered and reviewed before committing the full 12.

*"Beautiful enough to stop. Clear enough to trust. Simple enough to buy.
Memorable enough to return."*

Jared

SENIOR UI/UX · DRINK VARITEA